is appealing to the eyes of the customer. It sets the context of the merchandise in an aesthetically pleasing fashion, presenting them in a way that would convert the window shoppers into prospects and ultimately buyers of the product. A creative and talented retailer can use this upcoming art to breathe in new life into his store products. Passion for design and creativity are essential to be a good visual merchandiser. A perfect design process and the ability to create ideas that are different are required. Awareness of happenings in fashion world is needed so as to keep up-to-date with the dynamics of the market constantly. Visual merchandising includes window displays, signs, interior displays, cosmetic promotions and any other special sales promotions taking place.

12.8.1 Elements of Visual Merchandising

Visual Merchandising is commonly accepted as a merchandising technique that uses the visual elements effectively. Visual element refers to lighting, colours and signage. In short, they are the visual communications in the designing of an environment. Some of common tools used for visual merchandising are:

- **Mannequins**

It is a full bodied dummy of human form and it is available in all age groups from children to adults. Mannequins are used by apparel retailers to display their products in-store and in the window display. They are a tool used to show consumers what their products look like on a person. The mannequins will commonly be styled to match trends as well display the latest products available.

- **Forms**

A form is an imitation of some part of a body. It is generally used on top of a stand and serves to display articles of clothing and accessories.

- **Colour** is a significant tool used in visual merchandising. It can be used to influence the behaviour of consumers and evoke different reactions. Colour is a powerful tool in exterior displays. It can aid creativity for exterior window displays and can have a unique effect on the consumer. The use of colour can create atmosphere, grab the attention of by-passers, and attract them to the store. Different colours can trigger different emotional responses.
- **Light** can be used in many ways in retail stores, from highlighting an object or area of a store to simply illuminate the entire store

- **Store Fixtures**

Most common types of fixtures: Stands, Platforms and Elevations, Round rack , Bin , T-Stand , Four way face out

- Stands

Stands used in a variety or assortment window from glass line to the back of the display window

- Platforms and Elevations:

Platforms or elevations can be tables and other pieces of furniture that can be used to rise up mannequin, a form or arrangement of merchandise

- Round Racks:

Circular racks on which garments are hung around the entire circumference

- Bin

A rimmed table or bin used to hold sale or special merchandise on the sales floor,

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